

### THE VIRGO CLUSTER

Over 2,000 galaxies reside in the Virgo Cluster (see p.329), the nearest large cluster to us, some 50 million light-years away. The brightest of them are visible through amateur telescopes. Just below center is the elliptical galaxy M87 (see p.320), also known as the radio source Virgo A. M87 has an estimated mass of 2.4 trillion Suns, making it the largest galaxy in our region of the universe.

